artistic intervention, but its adjacent traumatized architecture could embody the division through an act of reconciliation.[29] (Christo and Jeanne-Claude eventually and famously carried out their project in 1995, after reunification, attracting millions of viewers.)

The range of American artists who worked in or on Berlin during this period included others who did not look to the Wall as a primary site of engagement, at least not explicitly, but instead benefited from the increased networks and cultural resources for artistic exchange.[30] Such artists included John Cage, Nam June Paik, Carolee Schneemann, Edward Kienholz, and others who ventured to West Berlin and produced significant artworks less directly focused on the city's division. Nor did the location of Berlin bind the production of representations of the city to its actual terrain. For example, Lou Reed's 1973 album *Berlin* is a woeful and spiraling narrative about destructive love in the shadow of the Wall, recorded before Reed ever set foot in the city. Later, as shared by biographer Anthony DeCurtis, Reed noted, "I love the idea of a divided city. … It was purely metaphorical."[31] But for other artists, those officially invited and those who ventured there on their accord, the Wall became a more embedded architectural facet of the city. West Berlin emerged, too, as a well-known space of creative refuge and tension.

By the late 1970s and early 1980s, other self-exiled or visiting American Berliners followed suit. Lindy Annis, Jonathan Borofsky, Allen Frame, Nan Goldin, John Gossage, Keith Haring, Gordon Matta Clark, Adrian Piper, Lawrence Weiner, David Wojnarowicz, Bill Van Parys, and many others visited or relocated to Berlin toward their own productive ends. Such identifications with Berlin included a relationship to the Wall as both a border site and a cultural meeting place and occurred without knowledge or insistence on the eventual Wall's end. Instead artists increasingly treated the city's division, at the Wall and elsewhere, as part of its despondent and chic identity, reflective of Berlin's emergent reputation as a postapocalyptic urban laboratory where anything goes as geopolitical conflict simmers.

Before arriving in West Berlin and prior to his Berlin Wall survey, Tajiri had in his previous projects considered militarized division as a foil of freedom. But divided Berlin's own border zones offered him new source material to explore such landscapes. Tajiri, Leonard Freed, and Angela Davis were